

5.1 Disk/Partition Management

The Internet plays host to many tools that cater to almost all conceivable disk-related issues. Let's take a look at how to manage hard disks and create partitions.

5.1.1 TestDisk (www.cgsecurity.org/testdisk.html)

TestDisk is a powerful data recovery software, and was primarily designed to help recover lost partitions and/or make non-booting disks bootable. These may be caused by faulty software, viruses, or human error. With TestDisk, even partition table (a filesystem table that contains information about how many and which types of partitions are on the disk) recovery becomes really easy.

When a hard disk drive crashes, the first thing to do is to make sure no more data is written to the drive. If we have a situation where the partition table is all right, but critical operating system files have been damaged, Windows will not boot. In such a case, if there is another OS installed on the system under consideration, the HDD may still be read. So, you can gain access to the files on your hard drive with a crashed OS by booting the computer with a DOS boot disk and then use a DOS-compatible file recovery program such as TestDisk.

In addition, we should mention that transferring the HDD to another computer prevents the drive from being written to accidentally, and could allow you to retrieve information from the disk. At times, all that is required is to use Windows Explorer (on the system to which the drive has been transferred) to look through the file structures.



Quick crash recovery with TestDisk